EMERGENCY HIGHWAY REPAIRS – SLAPTON ROAD WASHOUT SUPPORTING DECK

Urgent actions restoring critical road infrastructure quickly

CONTEXT AND SITUATION OVERVIEW

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EMERGENCY INCIDENT CONTEXT AND MEETING PURPOSE

Incident Cause and Impact

Severe weather and coastal overtopping caused highway washout and partial carriageway failure.

Emergency Response Coordination

Multidisciplinary teams aligned to coordinate a rapid and effective emergency response.

Response Objectives

Focus on safety, asset stabilization, and restoring connectivity quickly and safely.

Risk and Decision Context

Context frames risk, consequence, and statutory duty for urgent decision-making.

OBSERVED SITE CONDITIONS AND INITIAL SITUATION UPDATE

Physical Damage and Erosion

Severe erosion and undermining of the coastal edge caused structural damage to the road sub-base and carriageway.

Causes of Structural Failure

Prolonged rainfall, blocked drainage, and coastal surge combined to destabilize the road's supporting materials.

Safety and Risk Management

High risk to road users required precautionary full closure and highlighted the need for urgent stabilisation.

Ongoing Uncertainty and Monitoring

Potential for further deterioration emphasizes need for daily inspections and rapid progression to repairs.

SAFETY, TRAFFIC MANAGEMENT, AND ENGINEERING ASSESSMENT

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SAFETY MEASURES AND TRAFFIC MANAGEMENT ARRANGEMENTS

Road Closure for Safety

Complete road closure was essential due to structural uncertainty to ensure public safety and minimize risk.

Visibility and Warning Enhancements

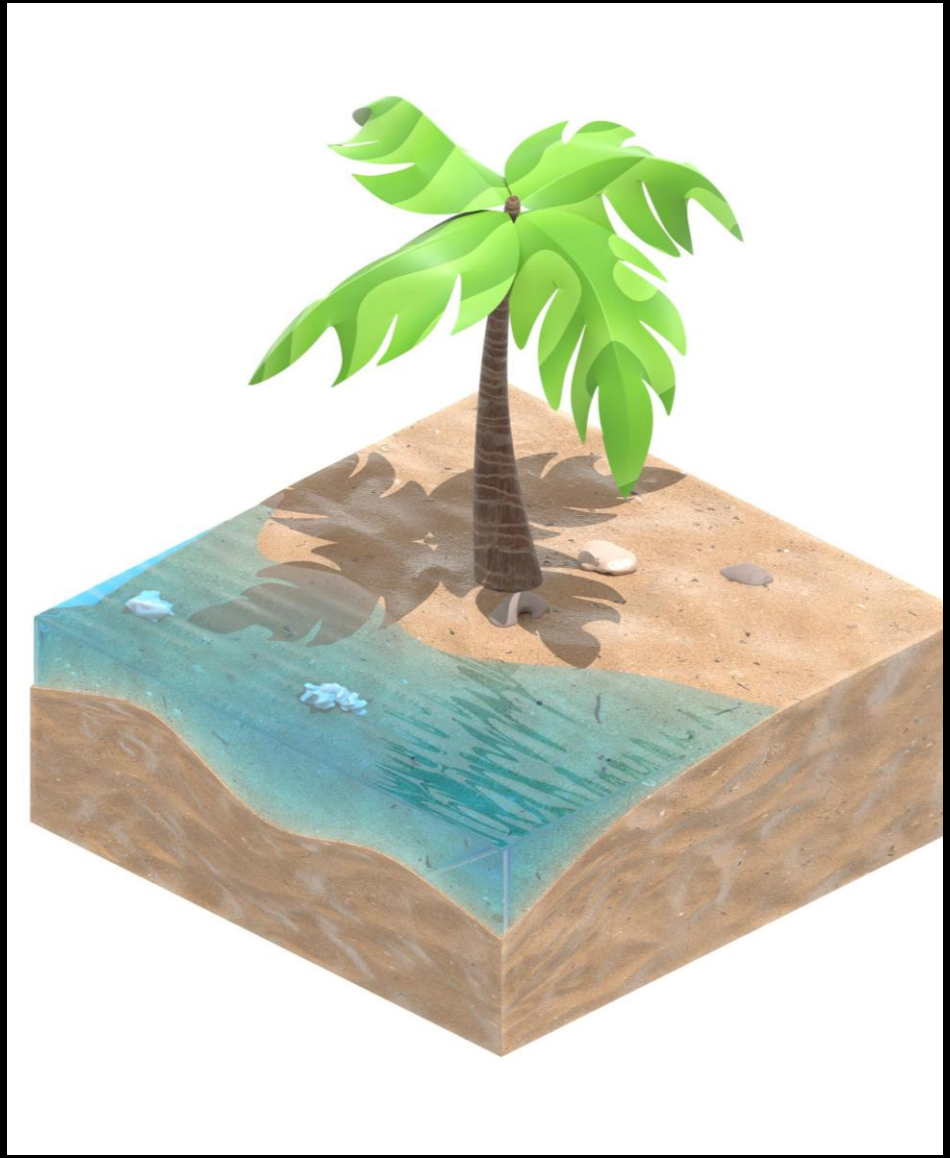
Additional lighting and warning signs are planned to improve night-time and adverse weather visibility for drivers.

Active Safety Management

Daily inspections ensure early detection of movement, cracking, or erosion, especially in changing coastal conditions.

Integrated Traffic and Engineering Planning

Traffic management was integrated with engineering plans to reduce public risk and legal liability during repairs.



ENGINEERING ASSESSMENT AND FAILURE MECHANISMS

Primary Failure Mechanism

Loss of sub-base support caused the failure, not just surface collapse, due to water ingress and drainage weaknesses.

Ongoing Risk and Deterioration

Further damage can occur with additional storms as exposed edges and damaged drainage lead to erosion pathways.

Two-Stage Response Approach

Immediate temporary stabilization is needed to stop damage, followed by detailed structural assessment for permanent repair.

REPAIR STRATEGY AND ENVIRONMENTAL CONSIDERATIONS

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ENVIRONMENTAL AND COASTAL RISK CONSIDERATIONS

Environmental Impact Minimization

Emergency works must minimize environmental impacts by using temporary, eco-friendly measures aligned with coastal management principles.

Concurrent Environmental Screening

Environmental assessments are conducted alongside engineering evaluations to identify constraints and mitigation needs early.

Stakeholder Engagement and Approvals

Permanent solutions require detailed assessments, regulatory approvals, and collaboration with local communities and environmental bodies.

RISKS, COMMUNICATIONS, AND NEXT STEPS

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KEY RISKS, DEPENDENCIES, AND MITIGATION MEASURES

Weather and Coastal Risks

Adverse weather may accelerate erosion and undermine temporary repairs, posing significant risks to project stability.

Access and Operational Challenges

Coastal conditions can restrict heavy machinery access, causing uncertainty in scheduling and project progress.

Reputational and Community Risks

Prolonged road closure without clear communication risks damaging community trust and reputation.

Comprehensive Mitigation Strategies

Contingency planning, flexible scheduling, and proactive inspections ensure risks are managed holistically and effectively.

AGREED ACTIONS, COMMUNICATIONS, AND NEXT STEPS

Key Decisions and Actions

Decisions include road closure continuation, emergency works, and parallel engineering, environmental, and communication activities.

Assigned Responsibilities and Timelines

Actions allocated with clear owners and deadlines including inspections, assessments, proposals, and communications updates.

Public Communication Focus

Emphasizes transparent, timely messaging on safety, uncertain timescales, and alternative routes to the public.